



DARKSTACK7

Cyber Defense

Penetration Testing

Cutting-Edge Network, Application, SaaS & AI Security Solutions

Why Choose DarkStack7?



Military-Grade Discipline

Founder-led with Marine Corps precision, combining tactical expertise with strategic global cybersecurity leadership across complex environments



Proven Track Record

Successfully managed large-scale, high-stakes security projects for Fortune 500 enterprises, government agencies, and critical infrastructure worldwide



Business-Focused Approach

Deep technical skills paired with clear, executive-level communication that translates complex security risks into actionable business value



Always-On Protection

24/7 managed security services and threat hunting capabilities spanning multiple time zones to protect your organization around the clock



DARKSTACK7

Cyber Defense

ai

Cybersecurity Leadership

(Hancock Bank, Booz Allen, EY, Wells Fargo, DeepSeas, Northrop Grumman)



Proven Leadership

Founded by Joshua R. Nicholson, former U.S. Marine Corps Sgt. with military-grade discipline and 24+ years of hands-on cybersecurity expertise

- Incident response Commander
- Security Engineer



Global Reach

Trusted by 450+ clients worldwide, delivering critical security transformations across the globe.

- International experience working in Europe, Asia, Middle East, and Australia)



Strategic Vision

CXO-level expertise spanning network architecture, incident response, cloud infrastructure, application security, and emerging AI risk management. Josh started his career in penetration testing and still stays current on tactics, techniques, and trends.

Network Penetration Testing: Defend Your Digital Perimeter

Comprehensive Network Defense

Our network penetration testing simulates sophisticated real-world attacks to uncover vulnerabilities before malicious actors do. We meticulously test firewalls, routers, switches, and network segmentation to ensure your infrastructure remains resilient.

Our experts leverage deep knowledge of network security architecture to prevent breaches that could expose sensitive data or disrupt critical operations.

Network security assessment (Internal & external)

- ☐ Comprehensive internal, external, Cloud network security assessments
- ☐ Access control validation and privilege escalation testing
- ☐ Wireless network security and vulnerability analysis
- ☐ Network segmentation design and effectiveness evaluation
- ☐ Lateral movement detection and response capability
- ☐ Ransomware attack simulation and resilience assessment
- ☐ LLM and AI agent adversary testing to evaluate emerging attack vectors
- ☐ Compromise assessment to identify active threats and attacker footholds
- ☐ Vulnerability Assessment



The DarkStack⁷ Process: From Discovery to Remediation



Scoping & Risk Assessment

Comprehensive environment analysis tailored to your specific infrastructure, applications, and business-critical assets



Penetration Testing

Certified experts deploy latest tools and proven methodologies to simulate real-world attacks and uncover vulnerabilities



Detailed Reporting

Prioritized findings with risk ratings, proof-of-concept evidence, and actionable remediation plans for immediate implementation



Executive Briefings & Support

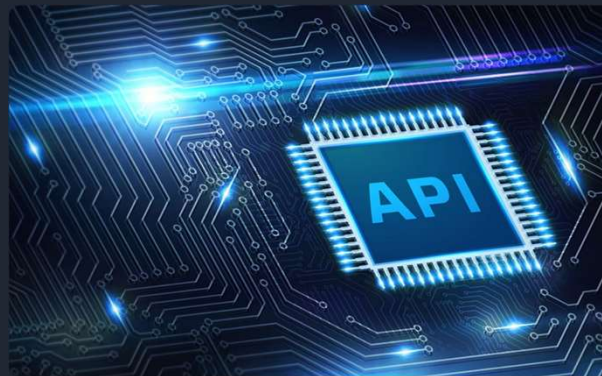
Clear communication with leadership teams and ongoing guidance to strengthen your security posture long-term

SaaS Penetration Testing: Protect Cloud-Delivered Services



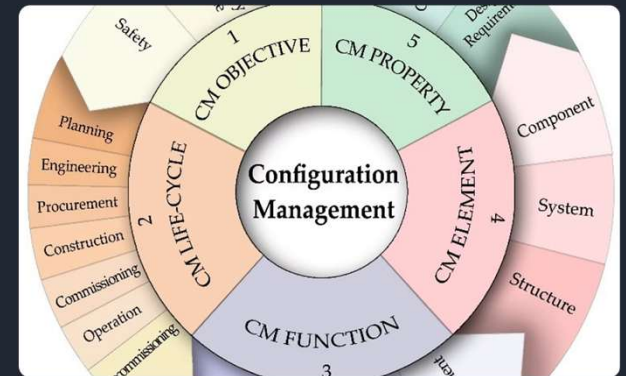
Cloud Security Assessment

Comprehensive evaluation of SaaS platforms hosted on AWS and major cloud providers, ensuring robust security posture



API & Access Controls

In-depth testing of API security, data encryption protocols, and identity & access management implementations



Configuration Review

Detect misconfigurations and potential data leakage risks in complex multi-tenant cloud environments

Support secure cloud adoption strategies that align with your business objectives while maintaining the highest security standards.

Web Application Testing Methodology: A Comprehensive Approach

Our rigorous web application testing methodology combines unauthenticated and authenticated assessments to provide a holistic view of your security posture. We simulate real-world attack scenarios, ensuring every vulnerability is identified across different user contexts.



External Attacker Perspective

Simulate attacks from an unauthenticated user's viewpoint, identifying initial entry points and critical vulnerabilities accessible without credentials.



Insider Threat Simulation

Assess security from the perspective of a legitimate, logged-in user, uncovering flaws that could be exploited by internal actors or compromised accounts.



Access Controls & Privilege Escalation

Thoroughly evaluate access controls and privilege boundaries using up to two distinct user roles, detecting potential privilege escalation and lateral movement paths.

This multi-faceted approach ensures a robust defense against a wide array of threats, providing actionable insights to fortify your web applications.

Application Penetration Testing: Secure Your Software

1

Comprehensive Testing

Web, mobile, and enterprise applications tested for OWASP Top 10 risks using advanced manual and automated techniques

2

Vulnerability Discovery

Identify injection flaws, authentication weaknesses, broken access controls, and critical business logic errors

3

Compliance Assurance

Ensure adherence to industry standards including PCI DSS, HIPAA, SOC 2, and regulatory requirements

4

Remediation Guidance

Detailed findings with actionable recommendations to strengthen application security posture

AI Penetration Testing: Safeguard Intelligent Systems



Emerging Threat Protection

As AI becomes central to business operations, securing these systems is critical. Our AI penetration testing addresses unique vulnerabilities in machine learning models and AI infrastructure.

- Adversarial attack simulation and defense
- Data poisoning and model manipulation testing
- Input validation and decision integrity evaluation
- AI-powered automation security assessment

Trust your AI-driven decisions while proactively mitigating sophisticated security risks.

Strategic Delivery Partners: Amplifying Expertise

DarkStack7 collaborates with specialized partners to provide comprehensive solutions for unique and demanding security scenarios.

Emulated Criminal



**Emulated
Criminals**

Specialized in advanced red teaming and adversary simulation, offering unparalleled insights into complex attack vectors.

OnDefend



Experts in rapid incident response and proactive defense strategies for swift threat containment and recovery.

Security Network Technologies



Deep expertise in cutting-edge network security technologies and infrastructure protection for specialized environments.

These partnerships enhance our capabilities, ensuring robust protection against emerging threats.

**AUDITROL**

Customer Success Story:



- Ashwin Nayak, CEO

"Darkstack7 conducted a penetration test and broader cybersecurity assessment that validated our existing controls and identified targeted areas for improvement.

The engagement was successful, well-managed, and provided practical guidance that strengthened our overall security posture."

The Challenge

AUDITROL needed independent security validation of their AI-integrated web application and API infrastructure to support third-party risk assurance and vendor security requirements.

Our Approach

DarkStack7 conducted comprehensive penetration testing focused on:

- API authorization and authentication mechanisms
- AI-enabled application components
- Business logic vulnerabilities
- External attack surface assessment
- Role based access and permission control
- Security reporting & logging

Results Delivered

- Identified high-severity API issues.
- authorization weaknesses
- Provided detailed remediation guidance
- Conducted formal retest validation
- Confirmed full resolution of material findings
- Enabled Auditrol to strengthen security posture, aligning with financial services industry standards

Slide 10

JN1 [@Liz Nicholson] This is what I need fixed. The word spacing.
Joshua Nicholson, 2026-03-17T14:31:47.937

Secure Your Future with DarkStack7

Protect your networks, applications, SaaS platforms, and AI systems from evolving cyber threats. Partner with a trusted leader who combines military precision with deep technical expertise to translate complex security risks into measurable business value.

☐ Ready to strengthen your security posture?

Contact us today to schedule your comprehensive penetration testing engagement and discover how DarkStack7 can protect your organization's most critical assets.

Schedule Consultatio

Visit DarkStack7.co

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